

All devices here were flat bed scanners and hence are capable of scanning any document. Sadly none had provisions for an Automatic document feeder (ADF) which is still offered on expensive models. Standard copying features were present on all models, while Canon and Brother offered additional features.

Canon's MX308 and Brother's DCP-350 had monochromatic two-line LCD displays while both Epson's made do with seven-segment LED displays. Installing these devices was a breeze, and none of them gave any specific problems. Epson's drivers and software are superior to both Canon and Brother. In Epson, the drivers offer better information about the device and the print jobs given. All devices came to be the required software bundled with none falling short of any items.

Overall Brother's DCP and Canon's MX308 came out as the better featured products, while Epson's CX-7300 closing following them. The CX5500 lacks most features but it is also the lowest priced of the lot.

Performance

The printing engine in Canon's MX308 comes from its PIXMA range of printers and as expected, it was quick, without sacrificing too much on print quality. Surprisingly, Epson's CX7300 delivered lightning-fast printing speed, even outperforming the generally faster PIXMA engine—sadly, at the expense of print quality. Brother's DCP-350 wasn't the fastest or slowest, but in the photo printout test took an unusually long time. Epson's CX-5500 lost to almost all printers here and took nearly double the time in each test we put it through.

Canon MX308's scanner performed the fastest. Epson's CX5500 did better in the scanner test and placed ahead of both the CX7300 and Brother's DCP-350—which were separated by a small margin of 2 seconds. When taking copies, Epson's CX-5500 was the fastest, followed by the Brother DCP-350 at second

and Canon's MX308 at third.

Coming to print quality, Canon seems to have got everything right. Be it plain text, infographics or photos, the MX308 is far ahead of the Brother and Epson devices. Lines have no jagged edges, text is pitch black and colour saturation is near perfect. These are the strengths of the PIXMA range of printers, and obviously, it shows. Epson and Brother were on almost equal terms—Brother was ahead in some tests Epson in others; Canon is in a class of its own, though.

In the scanner quality tests too Canon blew the competition away with good colour saturation, nice retention of details without overdoing sharpness. Epson's CX5500 did better than the CX7300 in the scanner test, delivering neutral results which were slightly behind Canon. The scanner unit on DCP-350 does good job but lacks the finesse seen in Canon. Although colour saturation is good, the image processing engine over sharpens the image and that results in loss of detail. Scanner units on all these devices are pretty good for scanning text, but Canon has an edge in photographs.

Canon's MX308 impressed us with its all round performance, delivering excellent results in terms of both speed and quality. Brother's DCP-350 takes the

second place here. Epson devices were a mix bag—the CX-7300 doing better in the print quality but CX-5500 performing better in scanning department.

Taking into consideration features and performance and putting price in the equation, Canon's MX-308 works out as the better product and hence wins our Best Buy award. Brother's DCP-350 is equally impressive as the canon but loses out in performance stake.

Mid-range MFDs

In the mid-range category, we have five MFDs—the Epson Stylus RX610, Brother MFC235C, Canon MX318, Epson CX8300 and Canon's MP476.

Features

Aesthetically, Brother's MFC-235C wins our vote as a pleasing device that anyone would love to keep on their desk. Nearly identical to the Brother DCP-350 in terms of design, the MFC-235C adds on a fax unit, but without a hand receiver. The use of dark colour for the lid, and the front panel on a white background gives the MFC-235C its sophisticated look. Epson's Stylus RX610 too is well designed but it's bulky and needs desk space. Canon MX318 is identical to the MX308 but with an attached ADF. Canon's MP476 is modelled over their PIXMA range of printers and is boxy and unappealing.



EPSON CD8300



CANON MP610

High resolution print engines are common in this range of MFDs and all devices here have it thus capable of delivering photo-quality output. Epson's CX-8300 and RX-610 both have just 64 KB of memory, while Brother's MFC-235C is equipped with 16 MB of buffer. This variance in buffer doesn't necessary bog down the Epson devices; can be inferred from performance figures. Canon devices use the system memory and processing to improve printing speeds.

Canon MP476, Epson CX8300 and Epson RX610 are equipped with memory card readers and hence the target people with need for printing photographs directly without needing a PC. These devices also have small LCD screens to help with photo printing—they can be used for previewing the photographs before hitting Print. You can also set the printer setting via this LCD screen.

Brother's MFC-235C and Canon's MX318 are oriented towards small office home office (SOHO) applications and hence have fax capabilities. Neither has a hand receiver, but both have a small numerical keypad for dialling. The Brother MFC-235C can hold up to 170 pages, against the 50 provided by the Canon MX-31. Canon ups the ante by providing an automatic document feeder (ADF) on the

MX318 which is missing on the Brother MFC-235C.

None of the devices in this category have automatic duplex printing support—if you intend to save paper, this is one feature you shouldn't do without. Basic and advance copying features are available in all devices. The Canon MF476 also has push scan and you can use certain features without a PC.

Since Canon's MP476 is capable of delivering photo-quality prints, it comes bundled with a host of software such as MP Navigator EX—a photo enhancing and touch up tool, Easy PhotoPrint EX—a photo printing suite. It also comes with ChromaLife 100 ink tanks—the ink has enhanced weather resistance, so photographs last longer. Epson's RX610 also comes from a similar mould and offers an equally impressive suite of software—however, the Canon is more intuitive and simpler to use.

Performance

In the printer speed test, Epson's RX-610 leads the pack taking the least time to complete the job. However it would be unfair to compare it with other devices which are priced lower than this high speed monster. Doing a fair comparison, Brother's MFC-235C competes directly with Epson's CX-8300 and gets

TOP GUN TECHNOLOGIES
The Best Network & Security Labs in India

Others Promise. We Deliver !

Integrated Program for Fresh Graduates
CCIE - Security
CCIE - R & S
On Enrollment Collect Appointment Letter
Rs. 6 lakhs P.A.*
Loans through **HDFC BANK**

Our Latest CCIEs 2008

Mr. Sibin S.S	CCIE # 21381
Mr. Vijay Kumar	CCIE # 21307
Mr. Avinash Kumar	CCIE # 21281
Mr. Vinay Chandran	CCIE # 20887
Mr. Rahul C Mukundan	CCIE # 20885
Mr. Deepu Nair	CCIE # 20750
Mr. Ullas Upendran	CCIE # 20617
Mr. Hidayath Ulla Shariff	CCIE # 20108
Mr. Parantap Rathii	CCIE # 20028
Mr. Anupam Dey	CCIE # 19964

Courses Offered:
CCIE, CCNP, CCNA, CCSP, CCIP, CWNA, CWNP, CWSP, CCSA, CCSE, CISSP

Lead Instructors :
AJAY PANDEY
B.E, MS (USA), CCIE # 14792, (Security / R&S), CISSP # 43675, CCSE, MCSE, ASAP.
P. RAMESH KUMAR
B.E, CCIE # 20107

Lab Equipped with :
85 Cisco Routers (3600, 2600, 2500, 1700, 700), 24 Cisco Catalyst Switches (5000, 3750, 3560, 3550, 3000, 2950, 2900), Frame - Relay / ISDN, 8 Firewalls : SonicWall, Watch guard, Cisco PIX 515 E (UR), ASA 5510, PIX 501, 3005 VPN concentrator, 4210 IPS sensor, Nokia IP 330, Check Point, CiscoWAP/ NICs, Cisco Call Manager MCS 7825

We have Graduated over 7000 CCNPs & 35 CCIEs.

Local Accomodation Available BANGALORE
Visit our Website : www.topguntechnologies.com
info@topguntechnologies.com
SMS 080- 65616600
080-23528500 / 41277710
If you find a better Institute to do any of these courses, Join it !